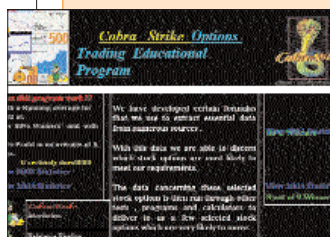


whatweretheythinking.com

www.cobrastrike.com

Somewhere, somehow, there's got to be a connection between Cobras and stock options. "Cobra strike options trading educational program," the page is called, and the main text says: "we have developed certain formulas... with this data we are able to discern which stock options are most likely to meet our requirements." OK, so it's something about investing. Then the pitch: "we offer to you the opportunity to purchase our cobra strike



straddle options calculator including instructions in e-book form." Now, on the left: "purchase of cobra strike" "monthly exercise #1"

And on it goes. The links, though, are on the Chinese-looking character to the left of the text.

Oh, we forgot: near the top is the following—"does this program work??"

With a running average for 2002 of: over 80% winners and with a

We're not biting this one...

45% profit in an average of 8 days. It certainly does!!!!!!"

"view 2002 statistics" "view 2003 statistics"

These two link to interesting JPEGs. The Chinese character features on these pages as well—he's a mascot of sorts. There's some good-versus-evil thing going on here, since the cobra is always juxtaposed opposite him.

Clicking on any of the "exercises" brings you to a page where you fork out \$2,500. Disclaimers dominate these shell-out pages. We clicked through to transfer our hard-earned money, but it was not to be—"Parameter Error"! We saw "http://mlm-norway.com/modules/" somewhere in the source—and you guessed it: mlm-norway looks like a get-rich-quick site. Cobrastrike.com is ostensibly a failed offshoot—the ringleaders seem to have abandoned work on the project when they found the cobra-stock connection wasn't apparent enough.

hearing. The lawsuit claims iPods are "inherently defective in design and are not sufficiently adorned with adequate warnings."

Also in the news these days are reports—yes, those officious-looking, billion-dollar-funded project reports—that iPods can cause hearing loss. Like we didn't know that. Like listening to anything at high volumes doesn't cause hearing loss.

This is just a repeat of what happened a couple of decades ago, when the Walkman was blamed for causing hearing loss. Why does the iPod manage to hog a goodish portion of the news every month?

Apple was forced to rework the iPod for France after it was shown to exceed the country's decibel limit of 100. But then, if you really want to damage your ears, you could just pick up a pair of lower-impedance headphones. You can take a horse to the water...

People in some countries use iPods to drown out the noise of subway trains: "The sound in the trains is

already high, so people pump up the volume levels on their players, just adding to the possible damage..." Can't Apple just advise people to use noise-cancelling phones? Or even bring out an iPod with a pair of those?

Now here's the latest: "More research is needed to determine whether popular portable music players like Apple Computer Inc.'s iPod increase the risk of hearing loss, the National Institutes of Health said." Yes, fund that research with a billion more dollars! Why isn't it part of common sense that if you use headphones for extended periods at loud volumes, your hearing is going to suffer?

On a serious note, though, ear-bud style phones, like the ones used with iPods, project sound directly into the ear canal, while earmuff-style ones allow the sound to diffuse. Apple should probably consider switching to earmuffs if they don't want these officious reports to lead to a class-action suit! ■

Blog WATCH

Some people think Google Mars isn't such a great idea. Then, there are people who think the Internet too isn't a great idea... And no one's sure if Origami is a great idea, but you can check out the timeline of its development. And finally, is blogging a good idea?

Joe

<http://snipurl.com/aprilblog1>
(<http://techdirt.com/articles/20060306/086230.shtml> #comments)

Don't Be Hurt, Internet, Some People Just Don't Care About You

Believe it or not, some people just aren't interested in the Internet. In recent years, the growth rate for Internet adoption has slowed dramatically, while those saying the Internet doesn't interest them outnumber those who can't afford to get online. What matters is whether individuals use their time productively and pleasurably, not whether that time is spent online...

Ouriel

<http://snipurl.com/aprilblog2>
(http://ouriel.typepad.com/myblog/2006/03/google_mars_thi.html)

Google mars: this is what happens when you have too much money...

Google just released mars.google.com. When my colleague told me so I thought it was a joke. But I checked further and I indeed find it. Doing Google earth was a smart idea. Copied by everyone since then. But Mars? What the hell are they going to do there? Locate the nearest pizzeria?

Come on guys. Make us a better down to earth search engine and invest your money in something that makes sense!

Dustin

<http://snipurl.com/aprilblog3>
(http://origamiproject.com/blogs/team_blog/archive/2006/03/09/19.aspx)

What's the Hubbub?

O.K., if you are reading this blog chances are you've in one way or another heard about the "Microsoft mystery" project named Origami. You probably also know by now that Origami was the Microsoft code name for the Ultra-Mobile PC project. We liked the code name so much we decided to use it for our community site, origamiproject.com.

So, what was that teaser all about? Well, since I was a primary driver of the buzz campaign, I thought I'd set the record straight by using a timeline to illustrate how events unfolded....

Jeff Jarvis

www.buzzmachine.com

Lesson No.1

Georgina Henry, an accomplished newspaper editor, makes the switch to blogging, heading up The Guardian's week-old Comment is Free, and she takes away the most important lesson: "the randomness, that sense of never quite knowing who's going to post when and what, is both the joy of the new site and slightly scary. It's the lack of control you feel you have at times - and control, I realise, is the one of the hardest things for editors to cede."